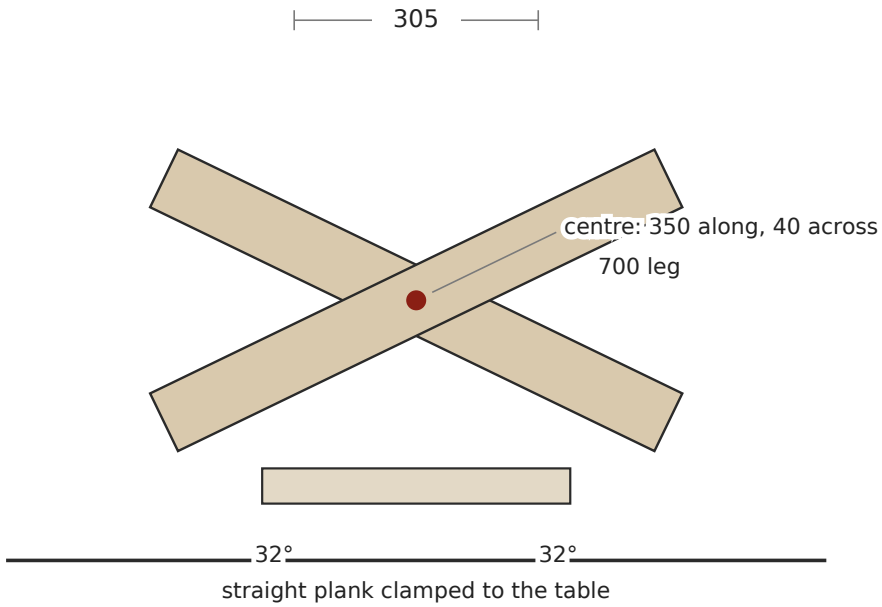
X-Leg Herb Trough

your build · draft v1

- Your numbers. Two X-leg frames carry a 900 long trough between them.
- Legs **4×700**, one end cut 32°. Cross planks **8×900**, four front and four back. Planks 80 wide × 23 thick.
- The trough sits in the V of the two X frames. Its floor is the first two 900s; the rest stack up the sides.
- The sides are not cut to a number. They are **scribed off an offcut** held in the V, one on top of the last.
- Shown at 900 long, four planks deep. Dimensions in mm.

X JOINT - stage 1 (schematic)



Stage 1 - the joint that decides the box. Two 700 legs crossed at their centres. The saw cut at the foot and the angle at the crossing set everything above them: get the crossing flush on the clamped plank and the two frames stand square. Confirm the two angles against your build photo.

CUT LIST

PART	QTY	LENGTH	WIDTH	THICK	NOTE
Leg	4	700	80	23	one end cut 32°, all four one setting
Cross plank (wall)	8	900	80	23	4 front, 4 back
Side piece	6	scribed	80	23	3 per end, marked off an offcut
- of those, the bottom pair	2	900	80	23	front edge cut 22.5°; back trimmed 23 mm

MATERIAL

- Untreated pine or hardwood. Untreated: it is a food bed.
- **35 mm part-threaded screws** for the crossing and the side courses.
- A **6 mm or 10 mm bolt** through each crossing if you want it to never move.
- Stainless or coated only. Wood oil (Woodoc) outside and on the feet.

Two rules that decide this build

- **One saw setting for all four feet.** Cut every 32° end off the same stop. One foot cut on its own and the box stands on three legs.
- **Lock the crossing.** A single screw lets the X scissor. Add 3-4 screws, or bolt it.

Open - to confirm against your build photo

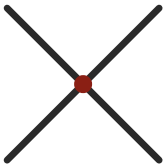
- The spec says the two X pieces sit at **22.5°** and the feet are cut at **32°**. On a 700 leg those two do not land on the same 305 mm top spread, so the hero drawing is schematic. Send the shot of the crossing and the foot and I fix the exact angles in v2.

The build in four stages

picture sequence

Four stages, in order. Do not start the sides until the walls are screwed down and level.

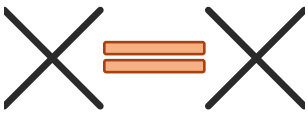
1



32° feet · screw the centre

Stage 1 - the X legs. Cut one end of each 700 leg at 32°. Cross two: centre 350 along, 40 across. Screw or bolt the crossing, 22.5°. Make two, mirrored - one plank inside, one outside, left and right.

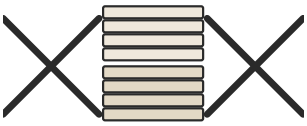
2



first two in the V

Stage 2 - stand them and start the floor. Stand the two X sets parallel. Cut one 900 at 22.5° to sit snug in the V. The back one lands 23 mm higher, so trim 23 mm off it so both tops come level.

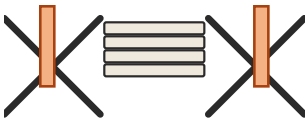
3



4 front + 4 back

Stage 3 - the rest of the 900s. 4 planks on the front, 4 on the back, flush with the left and right X. The back sits 23 mm proud behind the outside leg. Screw down front and back.

4



sides off an offcut

Stage 4 - the sides. Hold an offcut in the V, mark the angle, cut the first side piece. Next piece higher: mark off the first, cut, glue and screw on top. Third the same. Mirror the other end.

Stage by stage 1 – 2

#	STAGE	WHY
1	**The X legs.** • Four legs, 700 long. Cut **one end of each** at 32° - all four off the **same saw setting**. • Find the centre of each leg: 350 along, 40 across (half of 80). • Clamp a straight plank to the table. Press the 32° end flush against it. • Lay the second leg on top to make the X. Pilot hole at the centre. • Drive a 35 mm part-threaded screw so the two pieces sit at 22.5° and the foot sits flush to the clamped plank. About 305 mm between the two top corners. • Then 3-4 more screws, or swap to a 6 mm or 10 mm bolt through the crossing. • Make the second set a **mirror**: one plank inside, one outside, on both left and right.	• One saw setting for all four feet = feet that sit level. Cut them one at a time and they fight. • The clamped plank is the reference - it stops the X leaning while you screw. • A single screw lets the X scissor. Extra screws or a bolt lock the crossing. • Mirrored handed frames make the box symmetrical, so the trough sits level.
2	**Stand them and lay the first two planks.** • Stand the two X sets parallel, on the ground. • Lay the first two 900 planks in the V, one front, one back. • Cut **one edge of the front plank at 22.5°** so it sits snug in the V. • The back plank lands on top of the front, so it sits 23 mm higher. **Trim 23 mm off** it so both tops come level.	• Both X sets parallel = the box goes up straight. • The 22.5° cut makes the plank nest into the V, not rock on the corner. • Level first planks = level box. This is the one that sets it.

Stage by stage 3 – 4

#	STAGE	WHY
3	**Lay the rest of the 900s.** • Carry on stacking: 4 planks on the front, 4 on the back, one on top of the other. • All flush with the left and right X planks. • The back stacks 23 mm proud, behind the outside leg. • Both sides finish at the same height. • Screw the stack down, front and back, into the X frames.	• Flush to the X = straight walls, no stepping. • The back offset clears the leg, so both walls meet the frame the same way. • Equal height both sides = a level rim.
4	**The sides, scribed off an offcut.** • Hold an offcut horizontal in the bottom of the V. Draw a line from inside to mark the angle of the first side piece. • Cut to the line, fit it in the V. • Hold a longer offcut above the first, mark off it, cut the second, glue and screw it on top of the first. • Third the same, on top of the second. • Do the same for the opposite end.	• The V is not a set angle you can measure off a drawing - you scribe each piece off the one below. • Glue **and** screw: end grain is weak, the glue takes the load, the screws hold it while it sets. • Three pieces fill the end from the floor to the rim.